The Weekend Bookmark

What caught my eye on X this week

18 OCTOBER 2024 · NO. 1

WEEKEND EDITION

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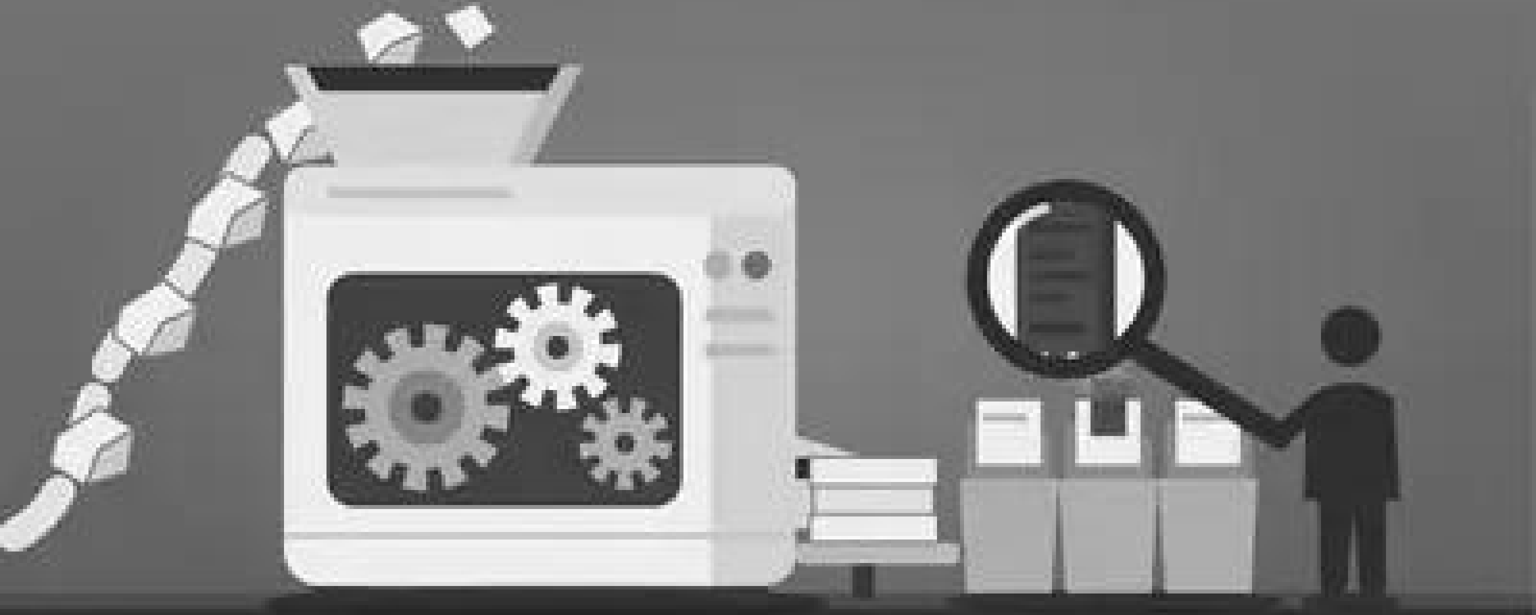

The Friday receipts machine

A Hamburg translator's agent now does her Friday receipts in 20 minutes, but a Steuerberater stresses its 27 backlog errors needed a human to find.

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QUOTE OF THE WEEK

"In a demo that's a rounding error. In a set of books it's 27 entries someone has to find."

Jonas Weidner (@jweidner_stb) · page 4

PRINTING THIS ISSUE

A4, double-sided, flip on long edge. To saddle-stitch, print as a booklet on four A3 sheets, flip on short edge, fold and staple twice.

The world this week

POLITICS

FROM THE BOOKMARKS

Philipp Jahn (@pjberlin) needed 31 sheets this year to register his daughter's birth, claim Elterngeld and change address; three asked for the same thing. The federal government has restated its one-login plan. @pjberlin

Grebsdorf, a Brandenburg village of 340, has switched off community Wi-Fi from Saturday night to Monday morning for a year. Sunday football rose from six players to 14, @feldnotizen_tom wrote. @feldnotizen_tom

Reparaturhof Kreuzberg (@reparaturhof_xb) saved 27 of 33 appliances at a courtyard repair Saturday. Herr Okonkwo, 79, a retired electrical engineer, says "Na bitte" after every working toaster, the group wrote. @reparaturhof_xb

Pupils in class 4b in Pankow collected 212 kilos of chestnuts in a week as winter feed for a wildlife park. Their teacher, Miriam Sommer (@frau_sommer_pankow), wrote that nine-year-olds weighed every bucket. @frau_sommer_pankow

Kalle Witt (@kreisliga_kalle), a 52-year-old goalkeeper, kept his first clean sheet in three seasons. The opponents arrived with nine men after their bus broke down in Zossen; it still counts, he wrote. @kreisliga_kalle

Dr Lea Hoffmann (@kraehen_protokoll) found her Friedrichshain courtyard crows arrive, on average, 11 minutes after the bin lorry. When a holiday moved collection to Wednesday, they came on Tuesday anyway. @kraehen_protokoll

Dr. Eva Marquardt (@eva_liest_studien) wrote that evidence people remember more from paper than screens is mixed; what seems to matter is reading "slowly, with a pencil, without switching". Paper, she wrote, is "not magic. It is a fence." @eva_liest_studien

Jakob Lenz (@lenz_automates) wrote that each surviving automation he built for Mittelstand firms began as a paper checklist followed for a month. @lenz_automates

Never miss a Saturday.
bkmk.to/subscribe

BUSINESS

FROM THE BOOKMARKS

Johanna Pfeiffer (@jpfeiffer_vc) wrote that the question in her LP meetings has shifted from growth speed to when a company makes money. With money dearer, "'sustainable' has stopped sounding like an excuse". @jpfeiffer_vc

Elif Demir (@elif_reads_10k), nine years an equity analyst in Frankfurt, wrote that the beat is "the least informative number in the release"; guidance for the next quarter and year is the news. @elif_reads_10k

Beatriz Moreno (@bea_buyside) added a sixth rule to Elif Demir's earnings checklist: read the notes. Footnotes, she wrote, hold changes to revenue recognition, new 'adjusted' metrics and quietly extended customer payment terms. @bea_buyside

Inês Carvalho (@ines_on_infra), who runs engineering at a 40-person Lisbon startup, wrote that running its own hardware would need at least two more engineers, costing more than its entire cloud bill. @ines_on_infra

Annika Voss (@annika_voss_ip), a Munich patent attorney, wrote that local AI is permission, not preference: client drafts cannot leave the building before filing, so "it never leaves the machine" satisfied her partners. @annika_voss_ip

Mareike Sommer (@mareike_books), who set up receipt and invoice agents for 30-odd small firms around Cologne, wrote that the agent is the easy part; most firms never wrote their procedure down. @mareike_books

Ben Okafor (@radwerk_ben) wrote that his Schöneberg bike workshop stopped opening on Mondays a year ago. Turnover has stayed flat and repairs are quicker, he said, because the team starts Tuesday rested with a clear bench; the unexpected benefit is that he no longer fixes bikes angry. @radwerk_ben

Tomás Ortega (@tomas_freelance) wrote that all 27 errors in his inbox were split payments, one receipt with two card transactions, and advised documenting them before the first run. @tomas_freelance

AUTOMATION

Write the procedure down first

AI AGENTS CAN FILE RECEIPTS AND CODE INVOICES, BUT ONLY FOR FIRMS THAT HAVE WRITTEN THEIR RULES DOWN, AND ONLY WHILE SOMEONE STILL CHECKS.

PROMPTED BY @lena_writes

ILLUSTRATION: AI-GENERATED FOR THIS ISSUE

Lena Hartmann
@lena_writes

POST

Every Friday at 4pm an agent now does my receipts. Not a demo, not a pitch deck: it started with 14 months of Belege, matched to bank transactions, renamed and filed. I'm a freelance translator in Hamburg and this is the most useful software I've set up in years. A thread on what actually works.

6 OCT 2026

bkmk.to/1a1

POST BY @LENA_WRITES

Firms asking whether an AI agent can do their bookkeeping are asking the wrong question. The useful question is whether they can say, step by step, how it is done now.[2] Lena Hartmann (@lena_writes), a freelance translator in Hamburg, wrote that her receipts agent "only worked once I wrote down how I do it by hand": two pages on which bank, which inbox and what counts as a match.[2]

Mareike Sommer (@mareike_books), who has set up agents for 30-odd small firms, wrote that the setups that worked had, before anyone touched a model, written down how documents arrive, where they go and who decides when something is odd.[3] German firms keeping digital books are expected to describe their record-keeping in a Verfahrensdokumentation; Sommer found those with a decent version were running within a week, while the rest spent a month discovering their own rules.[3]

Doris Hellwig (@hellwig_steuer), a tax adviser in Potsdam, wrote: "An agent will not find the rules in your head."[1] Jakob Lenz (@lenz_automates), who has spent 10 years building automations for Mittelstand firms, wrote that every automation of his that still works began as a paper checklist a human followed for a month; every failure, as a demo.[4]

A written procedure is no licence to stop reading the output. Hartmann's agent got 27 of 1,312 transactions wrong; all 27 were found at sign-off.[2] Jonas Weidner (@jweidner_stb), a Steuerberater, put that at about 2 per cent and wrote that "a missing Beleg can cost you the input VAT".[5]

At her 12-person studio in Rotterdam, Priya Raman (@priya_ops) ran an agent on 640 supplier invoices; it got 17 wrong but confident, four of which would have meant paying the wrong amount.[6] All were caught because nothing is paid without her click.[6]

Agents reward the dull firm that has written its procedure. Checking belongs in the design from the start: it keeps the books honest. For firms hoping the agent will impose order on chaos, Sommer has a warning: "It will reproduce your chaos faster, with better file names."[3] ■

SOURCES 1 @hellwig_steuer bkmk.to/1n3 2 @lena_writes bkmk.to/1a1 3 @mareike_books bkmk.to/1n3
4 @lenz_automates bkmk.to/1n4 5 @jweidner_stb bkmk.to/1a2 6 @priya_ops bkmk.to/1b5

THE ARGUMENT IN ONE LINE *An agent can only follow rules someone has written down; firms should write the procedure before buying the software.*

DIGITAL GOVERNMENT

One login, three questions

THE FEDERAL PLAN FOR A SINGLE DIGITAL ACCOUNT DESERVES SUPPORT.

PROMPTED BY @pjberlin

The government again promises one digital account for public services.[1] We back it. Philipp Jahn (@pjberlin) needed 31 sheets to register his daughter's birth, claim Elterngeld and change address.[1]

Ulrike Brandes (@u_brandes_it) asks who owns the data, who pays for upkeep and who serves people offline.[2]

Half those at her Kreuzberg advice desk lack an email login; they have a

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SOURCES 1 @pjberlin bkmk.to/1n5
2 @u_brandes_it bkmk.to/1d1

CLOUD COSTS

Read the bill

KNOWING WHAT YOU PAY FOR MATTERS MORE THAN WHERE YOU COMPUTE, BECAUSE NEITHER CLOUD NOR RENTED SERVERS FORGIVES A BILL NOBODY READS.

PROMPTED BY @mkrause_econ

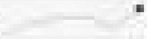
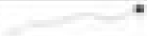
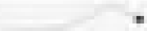
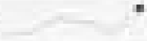
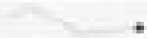
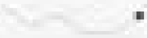
@mkrause_econ found 14 unowned environments on his firm's cloud invoice.[1] @dani_platform wrote moving three steady workloads to rented servers cut their costs by about a third.[2] Inês Carvalho (@ines_on_infra) wrote staffing her startup's own hardware would cost more than its cloud bill.[3]

SOURCES 1 @mkrause_econ bkmk.to/1c1
2 @dani_platform bkmk.to/1c2
3 @ines_on_infra bkmk.to/1n6

MARKETS

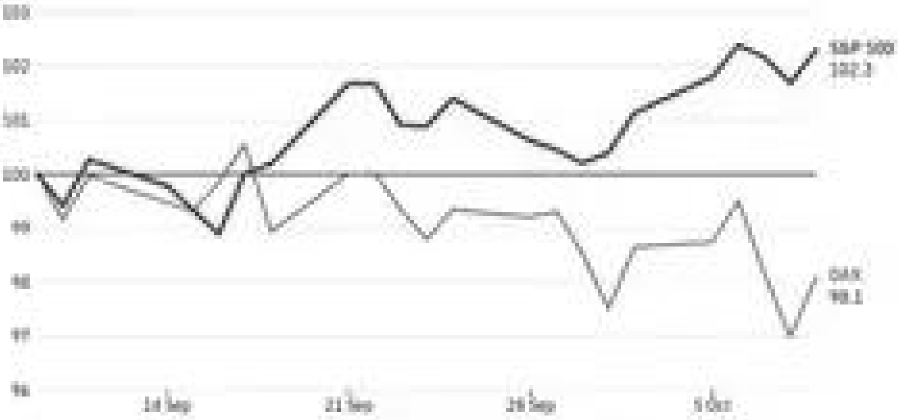
The week in the watchlist

10 STOCKS FROM THIS WEEK'S BOOKMARKS, HOW THEY MOVED, AND WHEN THEY REPORT NEXT

TICKER	COMPANY	LAST	WEEK	5 DAYS	NEXT RESULTS	BOOKMARKED BY
NVDA	Nvidia	—	–		18 Nov	
MSFT	Microsoft	—	–		28 Oct	
GOOGL	Alphabet	—	–		28 Oct	
AAPL	Apple	—	–		2 Nov	
ASML	ASML	—	–		14 Oct	
SAP	SAP	—	–		–	
SIE	Siemens	—	–		–	
RHM	Rheinmetall	—	–		–	
ZAL	Zalando	—	–		–	
DHER	Delivery Hero	—	–		–	

Wall Street rose as the DAX slipped

Index level and share price, 9 Sep 2026 = 100



Source: Yahoo Finance

MOVERS

Zalando +6.9%

Up 6.9% on the week to €23.80.

ZAL

ASML −4.7%

Down 4.7% on the week to $1,780.34.

ASML

SAP +4.1%

Up 4.1% on the week to €191.46.

SAP

Microsoft +3.4%

Up 3.4% on the week to $535.07.

MSFT

Nvidia −2.0%

NVDA

Rheinmetall −1.9%

RHM

Siemens −1.4%

SIE

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HOW TO READ THIS PAGE

Zalando leads a split week while ASML slips

HALF THE 10-STOCK WATCHLIST ROSE AND HALF FELL IN THE WEEK TO 9 OCTOBER, WHILE THE DAX AND S&P 500 MOVED IN OPPOSITE DIRECTIONS.

The 10-stock watchlist split evenly in the week to 9 October: five shares rose and five fell, according to Yahoo Finance prices. Zalando gained the most, up 6.9 per cent to €23.80, followed by SAP, up 4.1 per cent, and Microsoft, up 3.4 per cent. Alphabet added 2.4 per cent and Apple 0.9 per cent.[1]

ASML fell furthest, down 4.7 per cent to $1,780.34, with results listed by Nasdaq for 14 October. Nvidia lost 2.0 per cent, Rheinmetall 1.9 per cent and Siemens 1.4 per cent, while Delivery Hero slipped 0.2 per cent.[1]

The benchmarks diverged. The DAX fell 0.6 per cent over the week and the S&P 500 rose 1.2 per cent to 7,611.54. No post this week explains any of these moves.[1] ■

THE WEEKEND BOOKMARK

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THE WEEK AHEAD — RESULTS DATES

Wed 14	ASML results
Wed 28	Alphabet results
Wed 28	Microsoft results

SOURCES [1] Prices: Yahoo Finance chart bkmk.to/[id]

Prices: Yahoo Finance chart API; earnings: Nasdaq (frozen snapshot, closes to 9 October 2026); closing prices to 9 October 2026. Not investment advice.